

Current and Future States

The current data on shipping and returns within various different states is fairly comprehensive and useful. The desire of the data analysis is to determine the value of this business to stakeholders and to identify where market expansion is possible. The data currently available is about the number of returns and return percentages. The desired future state has the end goal of being able to reduce the number of returns, collect regional data on sales, and track the reasoning behind returns that do happen.

The Gap Between States

The data given is broken up between the data of returns via the different states and then returns on the different products for determining returns by product. There is no information on the number of sales in comparison to returns or a given reason for the returns. The returns and state also do not include the dates of sales or the update of data. Having the most recent data is vital for accurate analysis and reporting. Why the products are being returned is vital for the business given that there are many reasons to return a product from it's not the one the customer wanted, it was damaged in transport, or it doesn't work. If it's a case of damage in transport, then the way products are shipped will need to be altered. However, altering shipping methods does nothing if the reason for returning is because it's the wrong product. The information on what items are being returned can also include the frequency with which certain products are returned. Are they returned because they were expensive? Does the company need to revisit its return policy? These are all questions that could be better answered with more information provided.

From Current to Future State

The primary gap in the data is knowing why something was returned or what the most frequent reason for return is. Including a form with the return or introducing the question on return forms that asks “why are you returning this” would give the data while adding little to the process of returning things. There is also the possibility of tracking what items are frequently damaged when in transit.